



Var Gogh (ASCII Image Converter)

by Hugs for Bugs
(Abdi, Ayman, Elizabeth, James, & Lindsey)

Hugs for Bugs - Intro

Abdi: Troubleshooting and back-end development

Ayman: Front-end setup

Elizabeth: Troubleshooting and back-end development

James: Research and resources

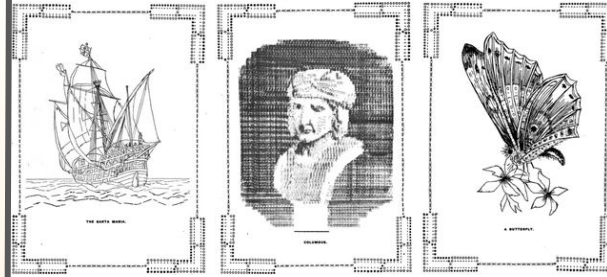
Lindsey: Troubleshooting/testing, logo creation and organization

*** We “mob programmed” most of the project.**



Pitch

- For the user that has an interest in the resurgence of “retro” internet trends, and would like to implement ASCII art in their online presence (comments, posts, profile pictures, etc.) via the ability to generate ASCII art from a photo of their choosing and easily copy/save it
- We wanted to create a version of an ASCII art generator that implemented technologies we hadn’t seen used in other ASCII art generators (React, Express)



“When in the 1880s typewriters became commonplace, this kind of image was done on the typewriter with letters or blank spaces, was known as typewriter art. In the first generation of computers, typewriter art was automated, and pictures of Washington, Lincoln, Harry Truman etc., were produced in this way. When computer output moved from the typed page to the television or video screen, the whole screen was subdivided into a certain large number, say 1,024 x 1,024 = 1,048,576 areas or so-called 'pixels', each of which could be addressed, shaded, coloured or otherwise transformed or manipulated.”

In other words, the decomposition of images into lots and lots of little marks was a conceptual step towards the pixel. In this telling, typewriter art is not merely an ancestor of ASCII art, but of everything that goes on a screen. The television, the CRT monitor, the iPhone.”

Source: <https://www.theatlantic.com/technology/archives/2014/01/the-lost-ancestors-of-ascii-art/283445/>

“Despite its development well into the twenty-first century, Microsoft declared ASCII art dead in 1998, calling it “cute, but useless” and denouncing: “These things were cool in their day. The problem is, their day is over.” Well, Twitter has brought ASCII art back to life, heralding in a resurgence with its largely text-based social media platform with memes so popular in part because anyone can create and spread them in seconds.”

Source: <https://unwinnable.com/2019/01/09/the-history-of-twitters-little-bunnies/>



{ \ / }
(. .)

/ > 🍌 Kelly, can u handle this?

{ \ / }
(. .)

/ > 🍌 Michelle, can u handle this?

{ \ / }
(. .)

/ > 🍌 Beyoncé, can u handle this?

{ \ / }
(. .)

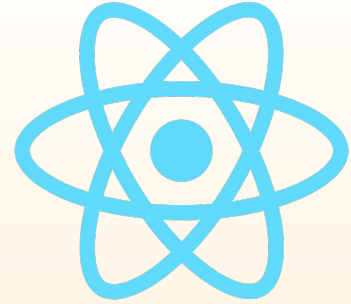
🍌 < \ I don't think u can handle this

Var Gogh Demo

Time for a demonstration!

Code & Technologies

- Node.js, React.js
- Express, Postman API
- ASCII library, VS Code Live Share
- Photoshop



Collaboration, Learnings, & Innovation

Collaboration

- Mob programming for project setup and throughout the development process
- Utilized “Live Share” extension for efficiency and merge conflict prevention
- Often referenced YouTube, StackOverflow, documentation, and tutorials
- Sought guidance from mentors
- We communicated well due to our early planning to use “Live Share” and rotating drivers, and preparing a resource document before starting

Learnings

- Be mindful of time constraints and keep goals simple (MVP)
- Learning when to move on to an alternative solution
- Importance of keeping track of resources/links
- Exploring new libraries & open source code

Innovation

- While searching for resources, we noticed there weren't any for creating an ASCII art app that uses the same “newer” technologies we chose to implement (React, Express)

Next Steps

- With more time, we would complete the front-end of our application
- We would add functionality for a user to copy and/or save the converted ASCII “image” for easier use in forums, chats, etc.
- Make a mobile-friendly version to easily use in messaging & social apps
- Expanding support for more input file types and online sources
- Provide correction for consistent ASCII “image” sizing & proportions

```
C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe

C:\Users\Trujli8\Desktop\var-gogh>node converter.js

#####
## IW##### IM##### tM#####
## +B##### +R##### +R#####
## V##### V##### Vw#####
## IW##### IM##### tM#####
## iB##### +B##### +R#####
## X##### V##### V#####
###R= IW#####R+ IW#####Bi IW#####
#####Mi iB#####Mt iB#####WI +B#####
#####WY -X#####WY X#####X X#####
#####X YW#####X= Vw#####B+ IW#####
#####Bi tM#####Bi iM#####MI iB#####
#####WI +R#####WI =R#####WV -R#####
#####WV V#####V V#####R= Vw###
#####WV V#####V V#####R= V###
#####WI +R#####WI =R#####WV =R#####
#####B+ tM#####Bi iM#####MI iM#####
#####X YW#####X= Yw#####B+ Yw#####
#####WI =X#####WY X#####V X#####
#####Bi iB#####Mt iB#####MI +B#####
###X= IW#####X= IW#####R+ IW#####
## X##### X##### = V#####
## iB##### +B##### +R#####
## IW##### IW##### tM#####
## X##### V##### Vw#####
## iB##### +B##### +R#####
## IW##### IW##### tM#####
#####
```

The End. Thank you!